

Multicultural Reflective Journal: All Journals for Portfolio

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I have no known conflict of interest to disclose.

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Multicultural Reflective Journal: The Role of Gender in Career Development**Summary**

Unfortunately, there are some familiar themes in this chapter. These themes are familiar not only from counselor education resources but also from personal experience. These themes of disparities, discrimination, and inability to entertain non-traditional careers for men and women are sadly deeply ingrained in our culture. The research-supported reports of women being held to a higher standard while not being seen as equal are not new to me. The idea of men as homemakers or serving in support roles being eschewed is also a thread in my experience and reading. The gap in pay between genders, the need for women to appear masculine to lead, and the stereotypes propagated in our nation's academia are all troubling realities. It is hard to read a chapter like this and not grow angry. Angry at my wife's experiences in the workplace. Angry at my friend's/sister's in Christ experience in the church. Angry at my own shame for taking whatever role I could (even if it was a support role) to help make ends meet in desperate times. These realities often seem too close to home and impossible to believe and remedy. The authors do an excellent job of offering solutions and self-awareness in the wake of these harsh truisms.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

One of the suggestions offered is an area of growth for me. I have done a fair amount of soul-searching when it comes to my treatment of women, but I can always do more. I believe the most essential disposition a counselor can hone is self-awareness. If we can ask ourselves where our biases lie and where they started, we can be a part of the solution. I often find myself taking the advice of the authors to think before I speak to women about career choices, desires, or callings. This August, I took a position at a Christian Liberal Arts University close to me. My supervisor (also the director of our department) happens to be female. She has some extreme

(this is not meant as a value statement, just an observation) views on marriage. I have been reading and re-evaluating my view on marriage along the egalitarian/complementarian spectrum. As I am doing this, I also ask myself how I see the women around me in general. As I was reading this chapter, I found myself fantasizing about how I would address a female senior leader who announced she was pregnant. Would I immediately react with joy for her? What if she wasn't that excited? What if she was more fearful than excited or choosing to bring the child into the world with reservations about her career? Would I assume that she was going to quit and stay home? Would I even ask about her plans for the future? I realized, with this little exercise, that I have some work to do on how my brain is connected to my heart and how my heart is connected to my mouth! I am certain that the only way to do this is to be honest with myself about my rigidity of thought and ask myself questions before I assume people are thinking what I am thinking.

Master's Students

Another moment of enlightenment for me was to place myself on the non-traditional career list...again. It has always been apparent to me that women are the majority in the counseling field. However, it never dawned on me that I could be considered non-traditional for being a male counselor. As I consider future emerging counselors, I wonder how I can balance the two truths. One is that men can be good counselors, and I want to encourage men to stick with their training and persevere through the bias. The other is that I do not want to demean women in any way by promoting men. Perhaps the solution is similar to broaching cultural differences. One of my colleagues at the University is doing her dissertation research in women in the classroom. She has found that when women are called upon to answer a question first, other women in the class feel safe and respond just as quickly as the men do. However, if a

question is posed and no one is called upon, it will statistically be a male student who answers first. This tells me that the instructor has a fair amount of influence on how safe women feel in the classroom. I will need to set up classrooms to be safe for all, talk about the biases openly, and manage the undertones of unspoken rules.

In addition, using an illustration/mindfulness exercise like the one I described above could help identify and correct biases in emerging counselors. When I read a chapter like this, I am struck with the amount of material to teach. However, when I think about integrating these lessons into the life of the classroom, it doesn't feel as daunting. For example, I could easily talk about gender bias when discussing any clinical case, whether the primary purpose was theory instruction, skills acquisition, or disposition building. If instructors will notice their own biases in the preparation period, we can pass along our process to students in the classroom.

Multicultural Reflective Journal: The Role of Race and Ethnicity in Career Development**Summary**

As I read this textbook, a few things come to mind. First, in pedagogy, it is becoming more evident that a strategy for helping students retain information is both present and helpful. Since the editors used the first chapters to exegete career development and counseling theories, they could use this as a template for how each chapter in this diversity section is outlined.

Writing about how the significant theories interact with race and ethnicity becomes a mirror of how these same theories interact with gender. The student can then see the Venn diagram at the end and see which theories apply to which situations and clients.

As the editors move us from the topic of gender to the topic of race and ethnicity, some similarities emerge concerning development and counseling. Most of these similarities relate to the history of oppression and discrimination. The solution, then, lies in the same concept of building awareness for clients, employers, and counselors. For clients, it is developing awareness of efficacy. This is not to blame the client for automatic negative thoughts about oneself; it is to help them interrupt and build on the positive they have. For employers, this is about growing awareness of discriminatory practices based on race in hiring and managing. For counselors, this awareness is crucial to broaching racial disparities and confusion.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

As a counselor and counselor educator, this last point is essential to bridging the divide in racial inequalities. I have been blessed to have a client base with various racial identities and ethnic backgrounds. I have had successes in broaching that moved the attunement needle toward the close side. I have also had misses in attempting to connect with clients of different racial and ethnic identities than me. As I read this chapter, I recognize that I have work to do, but I cannot

do it alone. I need my colleagues and their experiences and identities to help me grow in ways to broach the subject of race and ethnicity and to stay humble in my knowledge and skill. Where I may have succeeded in the past may have less to do with me and more with gracious and understanding clients. A better question for me is, how do I ask for grace, rather than how do I broach better?

As always, an individual view of individual clients interacting with individual counselors is the best way to conceptualize cultural humility for me. I mean that we can learn a lot about a race or ethnic group and find that the person in front of us has an entirely different experience. I had this experience with a couple whose family emigrated from South Korea. I broached the subject of racial and ethnic differences by stating the obvious: I am a white, middle-aged man who was born in Arkansas and lived in the South most of his life. You are first-generation Americans born in California to immigrant parents who have an entrenched South Korean identity. They answered me, "Nah, we are really just two white kids who look Korean." Okay...looks like we're good then...I guess.

Master's Students

My message to emerging counselors? Everyone you meet has a personal story; find out what it is. We can read about racial identities and what that means to certain people. We can read about ethnic experiences and what that means to cultures and groups. But what do those things mean to the person sitting in front of you? Similar to Jung, learn all the vital information you can about your client's background. Learn all the skills you can to warmly talk about those experiences and how they differ from yours. But, in the end, be another human being trying to help the person in front of you heal and meet their goals. Listen! Listen! Listen!

Multicultural Reflective Journal: The Role of Race and Ethnicity in Career Development**Summary**

This chapter was an attempt to consider and make changes for the impact that lower socioeconomic status and decreased access to services cause on some in the market. When the working poor (or underemployed as I've heard it called) and the unemployed look for resources or increases in pay or benefits, can they find them? And how do we address this issue if they can't? The idea of privilege as a barrier to extended career options was offered but not developed into a theory or processed with those lacking access. This chapter analyzed career development and counseling from the lens of social work and sociological and psychological perspectives of social class. Building on the growing research in the area of socioeconomic status (SES) since 2005, the authors evaluated the prevailing theories and how they consider and account for SES. Inequality, decent work, and precarious labor are also defined and introduced for the career counselor's knowledge and competency.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

The section on *implications for practice* reviews decent work and is a fitting start to what I need to grow in regarding issues of SES. Although I see the need to adjust my perspective on decent work (although one could argue that entry-level counseling is not decent work; it's difficult, sometimes unfulfilling, doesn't pay well, and burns people out), the idea of focusing on other positives in a client's life is appetizing to me. The more work I do with clients, the more positivity I want to have and the more hope I wish to offer.

As for other areas of growth, the headings of the conclusion section say it all for me. I need to grow in compassion, knowledge, generosity, awareness, and advocacy. This seems like a daunting task, but when I consider each of them as virtues, they make sense. I do not know what

it is like to live at or below the poverty line. I do not know what it is like to struggle to make ends meet year after year. But I do know what it's like to be human and in need. If I can see other humans struggling and choose compassion rather than avoidance, I will grow to help those needing jobs or better jobs. If I reflect on my life and how I spend my time and money, I can make room for giving and speaking out for others of less privilege. It's easy to see the person standing on the street corner asking for money and think to myself, "Get a job." But I heard recently that you need a physical address, an email, and transportation to get a job. Perspective on why others do what they do is essential in the helping profession.

Master's Students

Which is what I would focus on with Masters students. It feels treacherous to brainstorm about offering emerging counselors perspective and awareness without embarrassing or patronizing those in need. I remember being asked to visit an Alcoholics Anonymous meeting for my addictions class and thinking, "This isn't right! I can't identify as an alcoholic, and that's a rule for being here. And...these people deserve the best environment to get transparent!" I would hate to send students to a shelter or a pantry simply to get perspective. I would want them to see a need and desire to fill it. I would want them to befriend someone with less than they have. I would want them to think of practical ways to grow in competency. James 2:15-16 says it's missing the point to tell someone you are praying for them to have clothing and food without giving what you can to them. My left brain says we should watch some movies and develop advocacy ideas. My right brain says, get up and do something practical. Per usual, the answer probably lies somewhere in the corpus callosum...or middle ground.

Multicultural Reflective Journal: Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender Individuals**Summary**

Paying attention to issues relating to people's sexual orientation, sexual identity, and gender identity is proven to create positive outcomes for career goals in similar ways of other bias awareness. Creating good fits between interests, skills, and environment, supportive guidance, a positive mindset, and value congruity all place Lesbian, Gay, and Bisexual (LGB) people on the path to success in career choices and development. The mainstream models that the text has adopted as the most prolific ways of researching and counseling individuals on career choices all intersect with LGB people in some form or fashion as well. Although more research needs to be driven towards the use of career assessment tools, the models continue to tell a story of awareness and honesty shedding light on bias being the answer to opportunity for people with any disability; visible or invisible. Advocating for individuals and designing workplace cultures to include all voices is not optional.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

As I read this chapter, I had two voices in my head. One said, "Yes! All human beings have a right to decent work and to be treated with respect and as though they are intelligent beings no matter what they look like, act like, or believe about the world and themselves." The second voice said, "Is it okay to promote any narrative about gender other than the biblical narrative: the truth?" This is a tough line for me. It has ebbed and flowed over my career and education as a pastor and counselor. Now, as a counselor educator, the question is, why do I believe what I believe? The research from both the theological and psychological worlds seems to be widening to say two things: 1. God is love, and grace is enough, and 2. When we advocate for and speak peaceably to this population, they receive what we say. The research on page 382

of the text tells me that when people believe in themselves (and believe others believe in them), they succeed. The research from authors such as Yuan in his 2018 book *Holy Sexuality and the Gospel* tells us that when the church accepts the identity as reported by the person, they listen to our theology. But, I do not have to agree with your theology or narrative to help you as a pastor, counselor, or career counselor. I can love you and listen to you and offer advice when you ask and truth when you seek it. My growth area currently is more on speaking truth when it is unpopular. I can usually make sense of people's thoughts and behaviors. I have difficulty challenging them when their behavior is causing harm.

Master's Students

I would focus on this with Master's students. How do we challenge when it is appropriate to do so? It seems like educators and leaders are moving mountains to accept the narrative of the other gendered community. How do we recognize harmful behavior associated with this idea and call it out? Some dialogical exercises to create awareness of those with differing views could help set the tone. Then, some roleplay in supervised settings could help emerging counselors find language for confrontations and challenges. It would be essential to teach students how to maintain composure and hold their personal beliefs tight during this process. It would also be wise to teach them when to use immediacy and self in conjunction with a challenge of such high risk. Which is the crux of the matter, isn't it? It is both complex and awkward to challenge on such issues because they provide the fertile ground of conflict. Yet, we do this stuff every day. We listen to people with entirely different theology, worldviews, and lifestyles. We then have to decide when to speak to the content and when to speak to the context. The emerging counselor must navigate this when the risk is lower and success is possible.

Multicultural Reflective Journal: Career Development of Youth and Young Adults with Disabilities

Summary

I see three words that articulate the content of this chapter: efficacy, empowerment, and employment. Efficacy in this chapter is similar to discussions of self-awareness in previous chapters. Tied to Social Cognitive Career Theory (SCCT), efficacy is highlighted in this chapter as the one intrinsic dimension of individuals with disabilities that causes them trouble and that counselors should focus on when developing career treatment plans for them. Using SCCT to shore up an individual's efficacy seems to be an effective therapy. Having researched and presented on SCCT last week, I concur that the learning environment these individuals have been in all their lives would shape their hope of successful careers. If efficacy is the intrinsic dimension, then empowerment is the extrinsic dimension that counselors can focus on. Shifting from limiting these individuals on career choices to empowering them to utilize what skills, gifts, abilities, and knowledge they do have and can have is essential. We should see individuals with disabilities similarly to other minority populations when it comes to helping them develop career paths. That is, we expect capabilities rather than incapacities. The most impactful statement from this chapter should be addressed before any of these individuals make it to a counselor's office. When individuals with disabilities find paying jobs while still in school, they are more likely to succeed.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

Advocacy is still an area in which I see myself growing. I have been considering making an appointment with our university's disabilities coordinator to see what the outcome is for some of these students. I understand our university does a great job including, accommodating, and

loving these students, but I do wonder what the placement outcome is. As a counselor at the Student Counseling Center (or CAPS), I expect to be on the front lines of advocacy and empowerment for clients with disabilities. No one wants these student clients to fail, but, I have already (I started seeing clients here this semester) been faced with one student who was admitted and enrolled without knowing about an autism diagnosis. I had to assess and dig into the client's history to uncover this fact. I don't blame anyone, but it is cause for concern for me. I will be watching, listening, and speaking up for these student clients in the future.

Master's Students

In our graduate school, connecting some of these students as protégés could be possible. We are a small school and often have creative solutions for Master courses. I could see a multicultural course or a skills course utilizing some mentorships to build competency. Not only would it build competency, but compassion as well. This might be a good question for our graduate counseling director and our disabilities director. I wouldn't want it to be about course credit only. That being said, it could be an alternative assignment for those interested. Emerging school counselors might benefit from this kind of mentorship as well. An even better possibility would be to have traditional undergraduate students who have applied to graduate counseling programs shadow freshmen with disabilities. All of these ideas would take work but could be worth the effort.

Multicultural Reflective Journal: Career Development of Older Workers and Retirees**Summary**

Chapter fourteen of the text covered the late development of a career, changing the narrative about those who age while working, transitioning from the workplace to retirement and the extant literature on the matter. It also gave a brief overview of the most relevant theories and their viewpoints on the career development of older workers and transitioning to retirement. As discussed in the text, not much research exists on the matter of older workers in the workplace or retirement transition. The major theories covered in this text, although ambiguous at times, do add value to our understanding of this minority group. Three factors of cognitive development, affective development, and personality development outline the discussion in the literature review. Further discussion of how the major theories of life-span development theories inform our ability to assist people in this stage of development and life. All of these areas are drawn together with a summary word of attitude. Attitude toward work by older workers. Attitude of older workers by others in the workplace. And attitude toward retirement, the changing attitude of retirement, and the attitude of others toward retirees are all important factors in how people adjust to this new development period and their new lifestyles.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

This awareness of attitude flows into my area of growth. That is to say, I have a certain idea of what I want retirement to look like for myself. And, while there is nothing wrong with my own perspective, I shouldn't impose that on others looking to the next season for themselves. My parent's and grandparents' form of retirement will not suit me (at least I don't think it will), but that does not mean it will not suit others. Listening to the goals, values, needs, and attitudes of those seeking my direction could lead us to a completely different idea of retirement than my

own. I love the idea from the text of using a holistic approach to ensure the client's needs are addressed. Taking inventory of the client's physical, spiritual, emotional, and cognitive needs will lead us to a better solution for them. I also want to remind myself that I am not a financial counselor when meeting with this clientele. What they do with their money is none of my business. How much or how little they have. How much or how little they spend. None of that is any of my concerns, and I will need to focus on their mental well-being and whole-life care as we find solutions to the next season for them.

Master's Students

One area to focus on for teaching emerging counselors is creating meaningful work for older workers. There could be an attitude that an older person should not be in the workplace or that an older worker should be limited in their work. Noting the research from the text that many older workers do well and continue to thrive in the workplace well beyond what we might imagine is possible is fascinating and vital to me. When I look at my seventy-three-year-old father, I wonder if he should have retired almost fifteen years ago. I wonder if he shouldn't still be in the workplace every day in some capacity. His knowledge and experience alone make him a valuable source of wisdom and leadership. Introducing the idea that people well into their fourth-quarter of life can have meaningful work could help future counselors work with a different attitude towards clients.

Multicultural Reflective Journal: Nature, Importance, and Assessment of Interests**Summary**

How does one define a construct of counseling and assessment that is untestable by nature? The circular reasoning and justification noted by the authors of this chapter are not lost on me. They begin the chapter by stating that interests are essentially what the test measures. I understand this to mean that we are not helping define the interests of our clients; we are simply helping them determine and become aware of what they already know. Yet it is later declared that this is a significant factor in students' motivation to choose and train for a career. So, it is essential to assess clients for motivation and help the counselor deliver appropriate care to the client's individual interests.

Although, at first glance, interests may seem identical to personality and ability, the research identifies enough variants in the three that interests should be seen as separate and defined as an individual construct. In an attempt to achieve this, the authors delineate existing theories and emerging research. Preferences for expressed likes and dislikes is how the authors chose to define interests. The authors form their definition using cultural, social, developmental, and learned behaviors (nurture) and psychological, genetic, and biological factors (nature). The remainder of the chapter is a constructive discussion of the choice and use of assessments.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

I must say that I am lacking in the use of assessment tools for any conceptualization of clients. If I try to justify this fact by saying they are expensive or they take too much time (both of which are true), I am only denying the fact that I am lazy. I am thankful for my new clinical site this semester. It is a university student counseling center. The accountability provided and intentionality used to assess clients have been helpful. We use two initial assessments for each

client, and both help set a baseline for care. After reading this chapter, I am reevaluating other assessments that could be helpful to clients. I am going to ask about several of the career and developmental assessments and see if we can get access to those as well.

Master's Students

The short description of differences in gender interests was of great value to me. I plan to take this material and build out a lecture on this information for emerging counselors. The truth of the subject strikes me. We often want to believe that there are no differences in gender at all. However, this section makes it clear that, though they may not be what our patriarchal forefathers taught us they were, they still exist. And that is the short and long of it. We cannot assume that men do not like certain things because they are men. However, we cannot assume that women like certain things because they are women. Some tendencies and traits may exist and can be codified as male or female, but those are simply starting points, not reasons for bias. A good assignment for this would be to have them interview people for themselves and discover their own biases.

Multicultural Reflective Journal: Nature, Importance, and Assessment of Needs and Values

Summary

I realize this is not a critique, but this chapter was more difficult to follow than the previous chapters. The depth of the theoretical overview on such a considerable topic deserves an entire volume of its own. Yet the authors were given the task of summarizing nearly a hundred years of research in a few pages. Though difficult to follow, the chapter provided a strong base from which to build and ideas for emerging and potential research.

Beginning with a conceptual research history of both needs and values, the authors then provide a history of the significant theories that include needs and values as factors in career development. Starting with Murray from 1938 and Spranger from 1928, the authors tuned the reader into how these factors have historically been defined. Noting that many others have considered needs and values as equivalent, the authors obviously consider them dissimilar enough to differentiate the concepts. Needs are best remembered by Maslow's hierarchy, which contains physiological, security, social, self-esteem, and self-actualization needs. Values are best remembered as they are a central tenet in Super's TWA theory.

Research is then reviewed on three programs of recent interest: Dawis and Lofquist, Super, and Schwartz. These are then compared for their similarity in categorization. Specific assessments and theories are then delineated for how a clinician can best use needs and values as part of interventions. The authors argue that an informed career development must contain an understanding of needs and values in the lives of individuals. The fit with work and environment, as well as needs and values, are too critical to satisfaction to leave uncovered.

Reflections, challenges, and areas for growth

I have yet to see needs and values as critical as the authors argue. In fact, it appears that I am not alone, as they point out that many theories ignore these factors. One area for growth from this chapter could be understanding the slight yet existing difference in values among genders. In an attempt to equalize the genders, I may have missed that women are, indeed, different than men in some ways. We are similar, but we cannot highlight the similarities while missing the differences. This would dehumanize and disrespect the imago dei in all of us. Reading some research on how these differences affect the decisions people make and what fit and environment is essential in helping people find what's best for them and not the masses.

Master's Students

The theories presented in this book may never be offered to master's students except for a career course. Therefore, it would be helpful to describe and detail these specific theories and conceptualizations of needs and values. I remember briefly touching on Maslow, but not as it pertained to adult development. There are names in this chapter that I have never heard of and years of research I have never seen. If needs and values are as essential to fit as the author's purport, then these theories should be discussed at some point. I don't usually argue for adding theories and theoretical discussions to an already heavy load, but the number of theories in this book is small compared to the overall field. I believe they are concise enough to value their inclusion.

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